



Sweet smell of success: Lando Norris won the race after starting from fifth on the grid and dropping to sixth on the first lap. GETTY IMAGES

fortune favoured the brave, as a fortuitous safety car following an incident between Logan Sargeant and Kevin Magnussen allowed Norris a cheap pit stop and helped him retain the lead.

After that, Norris ensured he put daylight between himself and Verstappen's Red Bull—the dominant combo of the last four years. Despite having a faster car, Verstappen had no answer to Norris' pace in the last 21 laps, eventually finishing seven seconds behind the McLaren.

Big move

Although Norris was the main topic of discussion at the end of the Miami GP, the big news before the race was the announcement that design genius Adrian Newey would

leave Red Bull Racing at the beginning of next year. Newey has been with Red Bull since 2006 and has been responsible for the team's success so far. He is regarded as the greatest F1 car designer of all time, having designed championship-winning cars for three teams: Williams, McLaren, and Red Bull. Where Newey goes next could have a significant impact on the competitive order from 2026, when a new set of technical regulations will come into effect.

Newey has a proven track record of successfully executing the concept whenever new rules are introduced. There are already rumours linking him to Ferrari, who will have Hamilton on board next year, someone Newey has said he would like to work alongside. Newey's departure could also affect Verstappen's future with Red Bull, and it will be interesting to see if the team can still be competitive without its technical guru.

Moto GP



Meanwhile, reigning two-time champion Francesco Bagnaia got his second win of the season in the Spanish Grand Prix at Jerez. The Italian, who crashed out in the Sprint Race, made amends on Sunday, clinching victory after being involved in a superb battle with local hero Marc Marquez throughout the 25-lap race. The Ducati rider started seventh, quickly made up positions on the opening lap, and took the lead briefly before being repassed on the opening lap. Later, his title rival Jorge Martin managed to sneak ahead of the Italian but crashed out of the race on lap 11, allowing Bagnaia back into the lead. The defending champion faced pressure from Marquez in the final laps but held on to his lead, reducing his deficit to Martin by 18 points.



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